Your record goes with you. Every access is visible.

MediChain is a South African health record and emergency-access platform. A patient carries their emergency summary as a QR code or NFC card; a paramedic or clinician reads it in seconds on an approved device; and the patient sees every access to their record, by whom and why.

The problem

South African public facilities still depend heavily on paper folders. Studies in Limpopo found that missing records made patients wait longer and, in some cases, meant they were "treated without medical history" [1]. A 2024 review found that "numerous South African public health facilities fail to meet their record-keeping obligations as required by law" [2]. In an emergency, the information that matters most (allergies, medicines, chronic conditions, who to call) is often the hardest to find.

What MediChain does

- **Emergency access in seconds:** scan the patient's QR code with a phone or laptop camera, tap their NFC card on an Android phone, or type the card number. Access is time-limited, tied to an approved device and recorded.
- **Patients in control:** patients grant and withdraw staff access, sign or refuse consent, and see a full access history, including emergency access.
- **One record for the care team:** seven roles (patient, doctor, nurse, pharmacist, lab technician, paramedic, administrator) work from the same record: notes, orders, prescriptions, results, handovers and secure messages.
- **Works when the network does not:** if there is no connection, a scanned QR still shows the patient's own emergency summary, clearly labelled as unverified.

Where it stands

Live	7	1,045	276
on AWS in Cape Town, with HTTPS	roles, 116 screens	automated server tests passing	step role-journey check, every role

MediChain is a working proof of concept, built and run by one developer. It holds fictional data only: real patient data waits on legal and regulatory sign-off (POPIA authorisation and a registered Information Officer), which are tracked as release gates.

The ask

A clinic, hospital or EMS partner for a supervised pilot of one workflow, measuring how quickly staff find critical information and how well patients understand their access history.

Lukau Invasion (Pty) Ltd · 2026/600804/07 · founder-developer Keorapetswe Kgoatlha · 2nd place, Rust Africa Hackathon 2026

Sources

1. Marutha, N. S. & Ngoepe, M. (2017). The role of medical records in the provision of public healthcare services in the Limpopo province of South Africa. *South African Journal of Information Management*, 19(1), a873. https://doi.org/10.4102/sajim.v19i1.873
2. Kolawole, O. (2024). Non-compliant health record-keeping in South Africa: Judicial responses, and progress towards a digital remedy. *The African Journal of Information and Communication*, (33), 1–19. https://doi.org/10.23962/ajic.i33.18892